

JUSTICES AFFIRM BIRTHRIGHT CITIZENSHIP;
STATES' BANS ON TRANS ATHLETES UPHELD

Ideological Split
on Girls' Team
Eligibility

By ANN E. MARIMOW

WASHINGTON — A divided Supreme Court on Tuesday upheld two state laws barring the participation of transgender female athletes from girls' and women's sports teams.

The court's 6-to-3 ruling deals with laws from West Virginia and Idaho but has implications for the 25 other states with similar restrictions, and for athletes who compete in school and collegiate sports nationwide.

The Trump administration, which backed the state bans, has targeted the participation of transgender athletes in sports amid a national rollback of rights for transgender people. President Trump directed federal agencies last year to withdraw funding from schools that allow transgender athletes in girls' and women's sports.

The cases attracted intense public interest, with Olympians and other elite athletes watching closely and submitting legal briefs in support of each side. In March, the International Olympic Committee barred transgender athletes from competing in the women's category of the Olympics and said that all participants in those events must undergo genetic testing. The N.C.A.A. announced last year that it would bar trans women from competing in women's sports.

At the Supreme Court, Becky Pepper-Jackson, a high school student from West Virginia, and Lindsay Hecox, a college student in Idaho, challenged their respective states' laws, which both required that participation on sports teams for girls be based on "biological sex," defined as a person's birth sex.

Tuesday's ruling divided the court along ideological lines, with the conservative majority allowing states to determine eligibility for women's and girls' sports based on biological sex.

The Constitution and Title IX "do not require an overhaul of women's and girls' sports throughout America," Justice Brett M. Kavanaugh wrote.

"Allowing a biological male athlete to compete on a girls' team necessarily displaces or disadvantages a female athlete — replacing her on the roster, knocking her out of the starting lineup,

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Long Absent,
Kean Opens Up
On Depression

By ANNIE KARNI

WASHINGTON — Representative Thomas H. Kean Jr., the New Jersey Republican who vanished from Congress and the campaign trail in March with almost no explanation, said Tuesday that his long absence had been for a hospitalization to treat depression.

"Several months ago, due to health concerns, I entered the hospital for some testing," he said in a short speech on the House floor during his first day on Capitol Hill since disappearing more than 100 days ago. "I was given the diagnosis of depression."

Mr. Kean added: "Many people think it is feeling sad. It is so much more than that. It is physical, it is emotional, and until you experience it yourself," it is hard to understand "how powerful this illness could be."

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INTERNATIONAL A4-8

Tense Times in Moscow

Drone attacks on Russia have put pressure on President Vladimir V. Putin. On Monday, 419 were intercepted. PAGE A8

Motherhood Debate in Japan

Shoko Kawata is the first mayor to take maternity leave in the country's history. Some men are furious. PAGE A4



NATIONAL A9-17

\$126 Billion Budget Agreement

New York City's mayor and Council speaker reached a handshake deal on a spending plan that expands programs for housing and transit fares. PAGE A17

Summer in the City

Mayor Zohran Mamdani signed an order to protect people who work outside as daytime temperatures are expected to exceed 100 degrees. PAGE A17

Funding Family Travel

Senator Ruben Gallego, an Arizona Democrat, is under investigation for using campaign money to pay for flights and resort stays. PAGE A13

BUSINESS B1-5

I.P.O. of Internet Oldies

Bending Spoons, an Italian company that buys aging internet companies, is going public this week. PAGE B1

Chinese A.I. Closing the Gap

New technology from a Chinese company, Z.ai, is almost as good as its U.S. competitors but much cheaper. PAGE B1

SPORTS B6-9

U.S. Confronts Its Kryptonite

The men's soccer team seldom beats European opponents, but several may await in the World Cup's knockout stage. The test begins Wednesday. PAGE B6

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The Pursuit of Hungriness

We look at some of the inventions, crazes and cravings that have defined the American diet since the 1770s. PAGE D4

Baker's Timing Is Right

Justin Cherry specializes in 18th-century techniques, and his breads and knowledge are in demand. PAGE D8



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Treasures Return Home

Ancient artifacts held by the Metropolitan Museum of Art were sent back to their origin countries in June. PAGE C1

Mel Brooks's 100th Candle

We have a list of just why we love the comedy writer, director and star who just celebrated a milestone. PAGE C4

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The Editorial Board

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